

ITEP 310

INTRODUCTION TO ETHICS IN TECHNOLOGY AND BUSINESS

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TECHNOLOGY WITHIN SOCIETY KEY TERMS



refers to essential concepts and definitions related to the role of technology in shaping society. Understanding these terms helps students navigate discussions about how technological advancements interact with social, ethical, and business issues. Here are some key terms to include in this section:

- 1. Technology:** The application of scientific knowledge for practical purposes, especially in industry. It encompasses tools, systems, and methods used to solve problems or achieve objectives.
- 2. Society:** A group of individuals living together in an organized community, often sharing laws, values, and institutions that influence how they interact.

TECHNOLOGY WITHIN SOCIETY KEY TERMS



3. **Digital Divide:** The gap between those who have access to modern information and communication technologies and those who do not, often due to socioeconomic, geographical, or educational factors.

4. **Ethics:** Moral principles that govern a person's behavior or the conducting of an activity. In the context of technology, ethics involves the application of these principles to issues like privacy, security, and fairness in technology development and use.

5. **Innovation:** The process of creating new ideas, devices, or methods that significantly improve or change the way things are done. In the context of technology, this could include new software, hardware, or processes.

TECHNOLOGY WITHIN SOCIETY KEY TERMS



6. **Automation**: The use of technology to perform tasks that would otherwise require human intervention. This is increasingly prevalent in industries such as manufacturing, transportation, and healthcare.

7. **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**: A branch of computer science that deals with creating machines or systems capable of performing tasks that typically require human intelligence, such as decision-making, language translation, and problem-solving.

8. **Cybersecurity**: The practice of protecting systems, networks, and data from cyber attacks or unauthorized access. As technology becomes more integrated into society, the need for strong cybersecurity measures increases.

TECHNOLOGY WITHIN SOCIETY KEY TERMS



9. Data Privacy: The protection of personal data and information from unauthorized access, use, or disclosure. It is a crucial issue in an increasingly digital world.

10. Social Media: Online platforms that allow users to create, share, and interact with content. Social media has become a central part of modern society, affecting communication, relationships, and even politics.

11. Sustainability: The ability to meet current needs without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs. In technology, this often refers to environmentally-friendly innovations and practices.

TECHNOLOGY WITHIN SOCIETY KEY TERMS

12. Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR): The practice of businesses considering their impact on society and the environment in their operations and decision-making, beyond just profit generation.



COMPARISON OF DIFFERENT PERSPECTIVES FOR IDENTIFYING AND APPROACHING ETHICAL ISSUES IN TECHNOLOGY

Ethical Perspective	Core Idea	Application in Technology	Pros	Cons
Utilitarianism	Greatest good for the greatest number.	Focuses on outcomes, such as the benefits of a technology for most people (e.g., AI improving efficiency).	Clear, outcome-focused.	Can justify harming a minority for the majority's benefit.
Deontology	Ethics based on duties and rules, regardless of outcomes.	Focuses on respecting rights and following rules, like privacy laws in data collection.	Protects individual rights.	Can be rigid and overlook consequences.
Virtue Ethics	Ethics based on the character and virtues of individuals.	Evaluates the character of people creating/using technology (e.g., honesty, fairness in AI development).	Focuses on long-term moral development.	Hard to apply in specific decisions.

COMPARISON OF DIFFERENT PERSPECTIVES FOR IDENTIFYING AND APPROACHING ETHICAL ISSUES IN TECHNOLOGY

Ethical Perspective	Core Idea	Application in Technology	Pros	Cons
Relativism	Ethics depends on cultural or societal norms.	Evaluates technology use based on cultural values (e.g., what's acceptable in one society may not be in another).	Respects cultural differences.	Can justify harmful practices based on culture.
Care Ethics	Focus on relationships and care for others.	Emphasizes the impact of technology on relationships and vulnerable groups (e.g., automation's effect on care workers).	Promotes empathy and compassion.	<u>Can</u> be subjective and difficult to apply universally.
Social Contract Theory	Ethics arises from agreements among people for mutual benefit.	Evaluates technology use based on fairness and respect for agreements (e.g., data privacy agreements with users).	Focuses on fairness and collective benefit.	<u>Can</u> be vague when contracts are not clearly defined.

COMPARISON OF DIFFERENT PERSPECTIVES FOR IDENTIFYING AND APPROACHING ETHICAL ISSUES IN TECHNOLOGY

Ethical Perspective	Core Idea	Application in Technology	Pros	Cons
Feminist Ethics	Focus on gender equality and power dynamics.	Addresses biases in technology (e.g., facial recognition technology being biased against women or minorities).	Promotes inclusivity and diversity.	May focus too narrowly on gender or social justice issues.
Pragmatism	Ethics <u>based</u> on practical consequences and what works best.	Focuses on flexible, practical solutions for ethical issues in technology (e.g., balancing privacy with data usage).	Highly adaptable to real-world situations.	May prioritize expediency over deeper ethical concerns.

WHAT IS ETHICS?

- **Ethics refers to a set of moral principles that guide human behavior.**
- **It helps us determine what is right or wrong, fair or unfair, just or unjust in different situations.**
- **In IT and other professional fields, ethics ensures that individuals and organizations act responsibly, respecting laws, people, and societal values.**
- **In simple terms, it's about doing the right thing—not just legally, but morally.**

ETHICS IN BUSINESS WORLD

- In a business context, ethics involves applying moral principles to how a company operates and interacts with stakeholders (customers, employees, partners, society).
- It covers areas such as:
 - Honesty and transparency** in communication and transactions.
 - Fair treatment** of employees, customers, and competitors.
 - Corporate social responsibility (CSR)** – ensuring business decisions benefit society and do not harm people or the environment.
 - Compliance** with legal standards while going beyond the minimum to maintain integrity and trust.

ETHICS IN BUSINESS WORLD

Ultimately, business ethics protects a **company's reputation, builds trust, and contributes to long-term success.**



Class Brainstorm

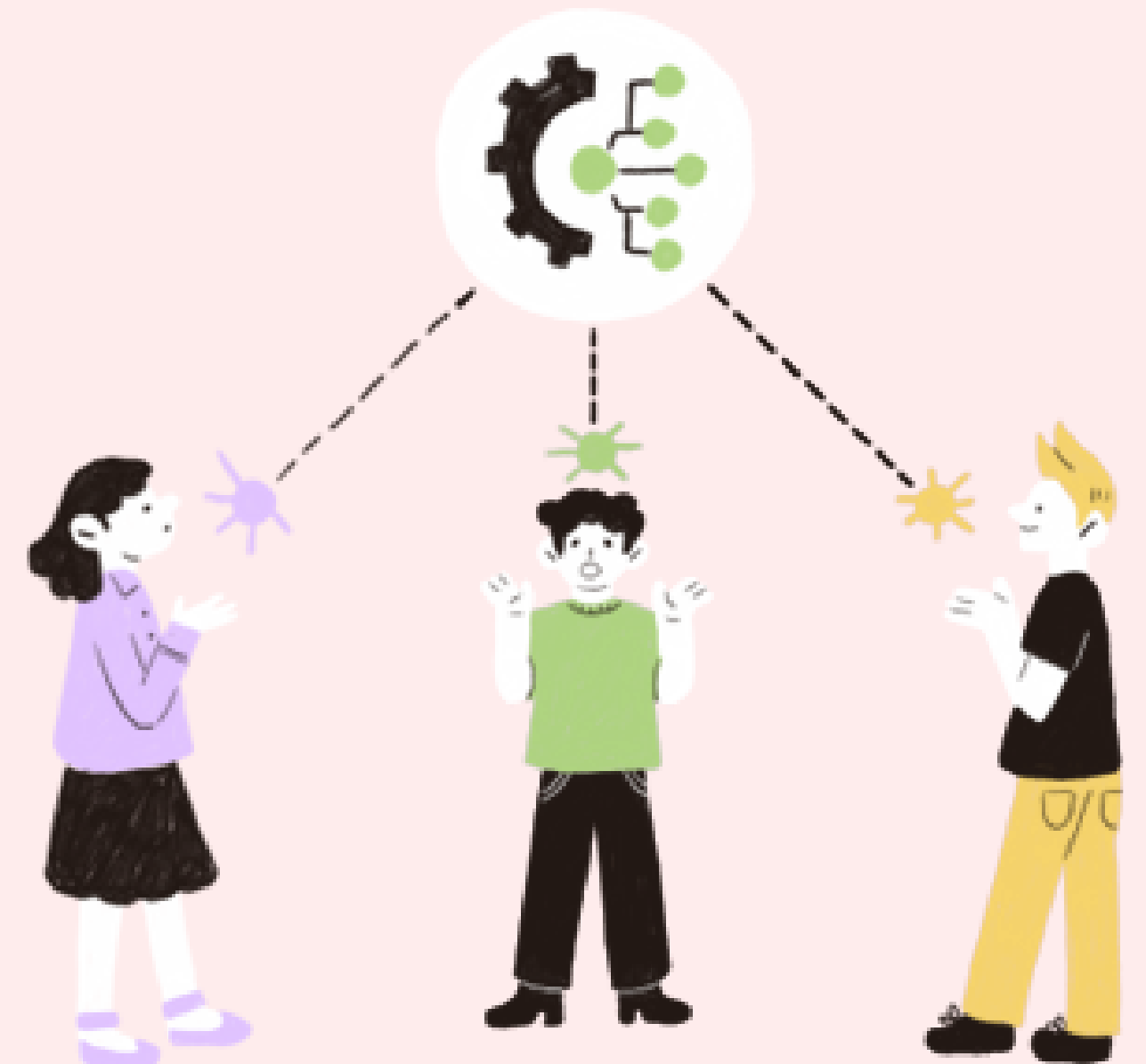
WHAT ARE ETHICS?



ETHICS AND DECISION-MAKING

Ethics are one of the most important factors influencing our decision-making processes. Ethics provides a foundation to navigate complex choices, daily interactions and dilemmas we face in our everyday lives.

By understanding ethics, we learn to guide our actions and decisions in a manner that upholds our moral values, ensuring outcomes that benefit not only ourselves but also society at large.



ETHICS AND DECISION-MAKING



Next, we will explore four major frameworks of ethics that shape our decisions:

Duty-Based Ethics

Virtue Ethics

Situation Ethics

Ethics of Care

Each framework offers distinct perspectives that enhance our ability to make informed ethical choices. Let's explore them together!

TYPES OF ETHICAL FRAMEWORKS

Duty-Based Ethics

Duty-Based Ethics (Deontology) asserts that morality is rooted in duties or rules, and the correctness of an action is determined not by its consequences but by whether it adheres to these rules. Actions are inherently right or wrong based on adherence to absolute rules, such as the duty to always tell the truth.

Situation Ethics

Situation ethics is a theory that prioritises the context and circumstances surrounding a moral decision more than absolute rules. Developed in the 1960s, this approach suggests that moral decisions should be based on what is the most loving thing to do in a particular situation, rejecting legalism entirely.

TYPES OF ETHICAL FRAMEWORKS

Virtue Ethics

Virtue ethics focuses on the inherent character and virtues of the individual making decisions rather than focusing on the rules to be followed or the consequences of the actions. This tradition, argues that the key to ethical behaviour lies in developing good habits of character, such as courage, temperance, and justice.

Ethics of Care

The ethics of care is a theory that emphasises interpersonal relationships and community as foundational to ethical reasoning. Unlike the more abstract approaches of other ethical theories, ethics of care centres on caring and maintaining the social bonds, valuing empathy, compassion and understanding of context.



Class Brainstorm

WHAT IS MORALITY?



INTRODUCTION TO MORALITY

Morality refers to the set of shared beliefs and standards that distinguish right from wrong behaviour within a community.

It guides our actions and decisions based on personal, social, or cultural values.

Morality serves as both an individual guide and a societal framework, essential for upholding order and proper conduct in human relations.



CATEGORIES OF MORAL BEHAVIOUR

There are three key categories used to evaluate behaviour in ethical discussions: moral, immoral, and amoral behaviour. These judgments help us grasp diverse beliefs about what is right and wrong, influencing how we understand and interact with the world.

Moral

Behaviour that adheres to society's recognised standards of what is right and wrong.

Immoral

Behaviour that violates society's established moral norms (generally considered "wrong").

Amoral

Behaviour that is indifferent to moral standards, neither "right" nor "wrong".

MORALS AND DECISION-MAKING



Similar to ethics, morality is another crucial factor influencing our decision-making processes. Morality acts as a personal and societal guideline that helps us discern right from wrong in various situations, from minor personal choices to major societal issues.

Morality significantly influences our decisions. It guides us in distinguishing right from wrong, shaping both our personal actions and our interactions with others.

MORALS AND DECISION-MAKING

Next, we will explore two major frameworks of morality that shape our decisions:

Moral Absolutism

Moral Relativism

Each framework offers distinct perspectives that enhance our ability to make informed moral choices. Let's explore them together!



TYPES OF MORAL FRAMEWORKS

Moral Absolutism

Moral absolutism asserts that moral principles are unchanging and universal. Under this framework, actions are deemed right or wrong based on their adherence to these absolute moral standards, regardless of context or consequence. For example, lying is always considered wrong, no matter the situation.

Moral Relativism

Moral relativism suggests that what is considered moral can vary from culture to culture and from person to person. This framework prioritises tolerance and understanding of differing views and holds that the best moral action is based upon the specific circumstances and cultural norms, advocating that there are no universal moral truths.

GROUP ACTIVITY: DEBATE

Should salaries be made transparent to all employees within a company?

Team A

Team B

GROUP ACTIVITY: DEBATE

Is it ethical for a company to track employees' locations through their company-issued devices?

Team A

Team B

GROUP ACTIVITY: DEBATE

Is it ethical for a company to hire family members of existing employees?

Team A

Team B



Thanks for playing!

THE END!

